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## Scope

This policy outlines our commitment and that of everyone working with us to manage and reduce the company's environmental impact. It applies to all activities carried out by the organisation and by anyone representing it, including employees, contractors, consultants, trainees, volunteers, and other associates. The policy is relevant to all roles and work settings, whether in the office, on-site, or remote. It covers both the actions we directly undertake and the wider impacts those actions may have.

## Senior Management Board Statement

The Senior Management Board of \*\*\*\*\* UKI is fully committed to and understands its responsibilities in minimising the company's impact on the environment, both locally within our offices and in the global environment.

This Policy:

- Defines the areas in which \*\*\*\*\* UKI believes its greatest impact on the environment lies.
- Commits \*\*\*\*\* UKI to minimising its impact on the environment.
- Outlines how it intends to put those aims into practice.

### Climate change advocacy

\*\*\*\*\* UKI will raise awareness of global warming and will promote ways of mitigating and adapting to its effects. We will consider the implications of climate change on our strategies, plans and activities. We will look for ways to support customers in reducing their carbon footprint however we can.

### Natural resources

\*\*\*\*\* UKI will promote the importance of conserving fossil fuels, and sustainable use of timber and water. It will adopt water and energy waste reduction measures.

### Waste

\*\*\*\*\* UKI will minimise waste by encouraging the prudent use of resources, and the recycling of waste electrical and electronic equipment wherever possible.

### Transport

\*\*\*\*\* UKI recognise that motor vehicle and aircraft journeys are a necessary part of its operations and will promote the use of more sustainable modes of transport wherever practical. Carbon offsetting will be adopted in respect of aircraft journeys. \*\*\*\*\* UKI hold an electric car fleet for those that are required to drive for work purposes.

### Purchasing and contracts

\*\*\*\*\* UKI will consider the impact on the environment of the goods and services that they seek to purchase and will consider that impact within the decision-making process. \*\*\*\*\* UKI also has a supplier code of conduct which includes sustainability obligations.

## Premises

We do not own any of the premises that we occupy, and we are usually one of the many tenants in a multi-tenanted building in all but a few locations. \*\*\*\*\* has notified its property agents that 'environmental awareness' of the prospective landlord and the energy efficiency of the premises is to be regarded as a key feature when renegotiating leases, considering increased service charges to cover the cost of new plant, or acquiring new office accommodation. Factors to be considered include:

- The energy efficiency of mechanical plant, such as boilers.
- The integrity of any fuel storage tanks and the procedures for testing these.
- The use of any form of renewable energy, such as solar panels.
- The energy efficiency of lighting etc. to our accommodation and communal areas, including motion activated automated lighting.
- The availability of natural light.
- The use in air conditioning plants of fresh air-based cooling systems with high efficiency motors, rather than traditional polluting and less efficient refrigerant based units.

\*\*\*\*\* do 'fit out' newly acquired office accommodation and refurbish existing premises. Where we do so, we will take the following into account:

- The energy efficiency of lighting that we provide to our accommodation. We specify low voltage motion activated automated lighting as a matter of course.
- Where we install air conditioning plant it should be of the type that uses fresh air-based cooling systems with high efficiency motors, rather than traditional polluting and less efficient refrigerant based units.

\*\*\*\*\* UKI

Senior Management Board

## Targets 2025

- Train 100% of employees on waste sorting and recycling practices.
- Train 100% of employees on energy-saving practices.
- Deliver climate awareness training to 100% of employees

# Environmental Procedures

## Introduction

We have identified key areas within our day-to-day activities that impact upon the environment, and we are committed to minimising their effects with positive on-going action:

- Office based activities:
  - Stationery supplies
  - Computers and IT consumables
  - Use of energy resources
  - Waste creation and disposal.
- Procurement of supplies
- Adjusting activities: Transportation: car, rail, and air travel.

## Office Activities

The following practices have been identified to reduce our impact on the environment and all employees should take responsibility for ensuring that these key steps are taken.

Saving power: reducing energy waste

### 1.1 Temperature control

Prevent energy waste through unnecessary use. Examples that should be addressed include having the heating and air conditioning running at the same time, or heating left on with windows open.

### 1.2 Switch off equipment and lighting when not in use.

As well as reducing the power used by the equipment, switching it off also saves on cooling or air conditioning costs. The monitor can account for a large proportion of the energy used by a computer. Employees should turn monitors off if they are going to be away from their desks for more than ten minutes, and make sure computers are switched off at the end of the day.

Switch lights off in empty rooms.

Take care not to compromise safety by switching off any critical equipment at times when it might be needed.

Unplug mobile phone chargers/battery chargers etc. from the power supply once items have been charged.

### 1.3 Use energy-efficient equipment

When considering the purchase of new equipment, \*\*\*\*\* UKI will compare energy ratings and make informed purchases to invest in products that will minimise energy consumption in the future.

### 1.4 Audio and Video Conferencing

\*\*\*\*\* encourages extensive use of video and audio conferencing.

\*\*\*\*\* will document or refer to any changes that have emerged because of flexible working and Covid- 19 such as installation of video conferencing in offices or provision of hardware and software to enable virtual meetings such as zoom, teams, etc.

## 2. Reducing stationery and consumables

The cheapest option, and the best for the environment, is to reduce the amount of paper waste that our business produces by:

- Avoiding overproducing marketing and publicity material by reviewing distribution lists and regularly updating databases.
- reducing the need for printing.
- All correspondence is via email reducing the need to print unless a vulnerable customer requires communication via a form of letter.
- Cancelling junk mail and unwanted publications.
- Where printing is required, use both sides of the paper. Whenever possible use double sided photocopying – if required.
- Photocopiers and printers should always be reset to single copy printing after someone has used them, employees should check the number of copies setting before using them.
- The need for computer printouts should be reviewed on a regular basis.
- Use the smallest piece of paper appropriate to the task.
- Training staff to ensure they are competent in their roles, thus avoiding wasteful errors.
- Providing training for employees on all new equipment to ensure that they are comfortable with using this to its full potential.

## 3. Recycling

All offices should recycle paper rather than dispose of it within general office waste (where required). To ensure that this is possible, the following processes should be adopted:

- Ensure a recycling waste collection contract is in place at each site.
- Ensure recycling bins are in all offices. A good guide is one bin between six staff and one next to each photocopier and printer.
- Ensure that cleaning staff/serviced office contractors support the recycling scheme and that emptying the recycling bins is part of their contracted work.
- Computers and electronic equipment including mobile phones and batteries should be returned to the IT Dept for safe disposal or recycling programmes that are in place.

## 4. Other Waste – Responsible Disposal

All locations must ensure that all waste, where recycled, landfill, and contaminated (such as sanitary waste) is handled by an authorised organisation - such as the local authority or a registered contractor and taken to an authorised site.

# Ensuring compliance with legislation

All Directors are responsible for checking that locations meet the requirements set out in the attached checklist. Where the location is a serviced office, this checklist should be supplied to the managing agents for completion to confirm that all requirements are met. **(See Appendix 1)**

## Green Procurement

Everyone in our business must consider energy efficiency in their buying decisions: This should affect everything from replacing light bulbs to major capital investments.

When choosing new equipment, \*\*\*\*\* UKI considers the environmental credentials of the supplier as part of the specification process.

We work in close partnership with our suppliers to ensure that they maintain their own high environmental standards.

As a service provider, through adopting and adhering to the measures set out in our environmental policy and procedure, we help our clients to meet their environmental targets.

## Reduce the environmental impact of our business travel.

The mobility of our employees is a key element of our adjusting business, but wherever possible we encourage all employees to contribute towards improving our environmental performance.

Employees should think in advance about journeys:

- Could a face-to-face meeting be replaced by a Teams or a call (use of our video call (name???)
- Appointments in the same area are arranged for the same day wherever possible.
- Employees are encouraged to make use of journey planning tools to ensure that the most efficient route is taken to any location.
- Consider travel by rail/public transport whenever possible.
- Where air travel is unavoidable, we undertake to off-set our carbon footprint in this regard.

## Carbon Offsetting/Planet Mark

Where air travel is unavoidable, we will calculate the carbon footprint created by such travel using the carbon footprint calculator recommended by the Department of Energy and Climate Change and purchase offsets to fund validated emissions reducing projects.

\*\*\*\*\* globally has achieved Planet Mark Accreditation and is now on a journey to reduce its global carbon footprint by 2.5% year on year. **(See appendix 2)**

## Environmentally Aware Culture

The Senior Management board of \*\*\*\*\* UKI place great importance upon encouraging an environmentally aware culture throughout the Company.

- Sufficient management resources are allocated to ensure effective implementation of our environmental procedures.
- All employees are encouraged to contribute energy saving ideas.
- They are trained to minimise wastage due to errors.

The Senior Management Board of \*\*\*\*\* UKI is committed to monitoring progress and the continuing improvement of procedures to minimise our impact on the environment.

# Appendix 1 – Environmental checklist for offices

## Environmental legislation checklist for offices

Use our checklist to see if your office is complying with environmental legislation.

### Comply with your duty of care when moving and pre-treating waste.

- Designate different storage areas for each waste type, e.g., plastics, cardboard, glass, cans, food waste.
- Check that the containers you use for moving your waste are in good condition and waste can't escape.
- Check that anyone who takes any waste away from your office is authorised to do so.
- Ask to see their waste carriers' certificate – remember to recheck these details regularly as registrations can expire or be revoked.
- Complete waste transfer notes every time someone takes waste away from your office.
- You should check that your waste ends up where your waste carrier says it does. You should check periodically that your waste is being disposed of correctly - remember it is your responsibility (your duty of care) to check if you think your waste may be being fly-tipped.
- If you take your own office waste to a disposal site, check that they have a permit or exemption.
- Complete a waste transfer note if you take your waste to a disposal site. If you regularly transport your own business waste, you need to register with your environmental regulator.
- Keep waste transfer notes for two years.
- Complete consignment notes for all hazardous/special waste that leaves your office.
- Keep consignment notes and return to producer forms (for hazardous/special waste) for three years.
- Pre-treat your waste before it goes to landfill. If you use a waste contractor, check that they are pre-treating your waste before it is landfilled.
- Keep records to prove that your waste has been pre-treated.

### Comply with waste electrical and electronic equipment regulations.

- Check which office equipment is covered by the Waste Electrical and Electronic Equipment (WEEE) Regulations, e.g., computers, printers, and mobile phones. You may also have kitchen equipment such as microwaves, fridges, or vending machines.
  - For IT related equipment please refer to the IT Global Asset Policy.
- Check whether any of your office WEEE is classed as hazardous/special waste. You will need to complete consignment notes when disposing of these items.
- Check that you have the producer registration number for your EEE. Use this to contact the producer for details of their compliance scheme and take-back system when you need to dispose of these products.
- In some cases, disposal of your office WEEE will be free.



- Store your WEEE separately from your general (non-hazardous) office waste.
- Keep records to prove that your WEEE has been treated and disposed of in an environmentally sound way.
- Make sure you comply with your duty of care for your WEEE.

### **Handle hazardous/special waste correctly.**

- Check how much hazardous/special waste you produce at your office. Hazardous/special waste includes fluorescent light tubes, energy saving bulbs, toner and ink cartridges from printers and photocopiers and old computer monitors.
- Pre-notify your environmental regulator three days before moving your hazardous/special waste.
- Store hazardous/special waste separately from your general (non-hazardous) waste.
- Make sure you comply with your duty of care for your hazardous/special waste.

### **Check your air-conditioning.**

- Check what type of refrigerant your air-conditioning equipment contains.
- If your refrigerant is an ozone-depleting substance (ODS) or fluorinated gas (F-gas) you will have to comply with requirements for servicing and maintaining these systems.
- Check that anyone who services or decommissions your air-conditioning equipment holds a recognised minimum qualification for the refrigerant you use.
- Test your air-conditioning equipment regularly for leaks. If your equipment contains over 3kg of ODS or F-gas you will have to do this at least once a year.
- Keep records about your air-conditioning equipment, including service history.
- Recover ODS or F-gases during servicing, maintenance and at the end of equipment's life.

### **Manage the energy performance of your buildings.**

- Check whether you need to register your energy use (electricity, gas, fuel oil) under the CRC Energy Efficiency Scheme.
- Check you have an Energy Performance Certificate (EPC) for your commercial building (e.g., an office) when it is sold, rented, or built. Recheck this regularly as an EPC is valid for 10 years.
- Check that the EPC is produced by an energy assessor accredited by a recognised accreditation scheme and with the appropriate qualifications.
- Make sure your air-conditioning equipment is inspected by an accredited energy assessor.

### **Review**

This policy shall undergo an annual review and be revised whenever necessary to remain compliant with relevant legislative changes. The Managing Director is ultimately accountable for the policy's effectiveness, overseeing the establishment and tracking of the company's environmental targets, objectives, and goals, and ensuring they are properly achieved.

If you have any suggested changes to this procedure, please notify: